

SOCIETY OF

BLACK ENGINEERS



THE
CORNERSTONE



SOCIETY OF BLACK ENGINEERS

Society Calendar Fall Semester '74

October 7 Inland Steel — guest speaker

October 14 **Ed Barnett** — Purdue Graduate, first president SBE now with Proctor and Gamble (Charmin Division)

October 21 Eastman Kodak — guest speaker

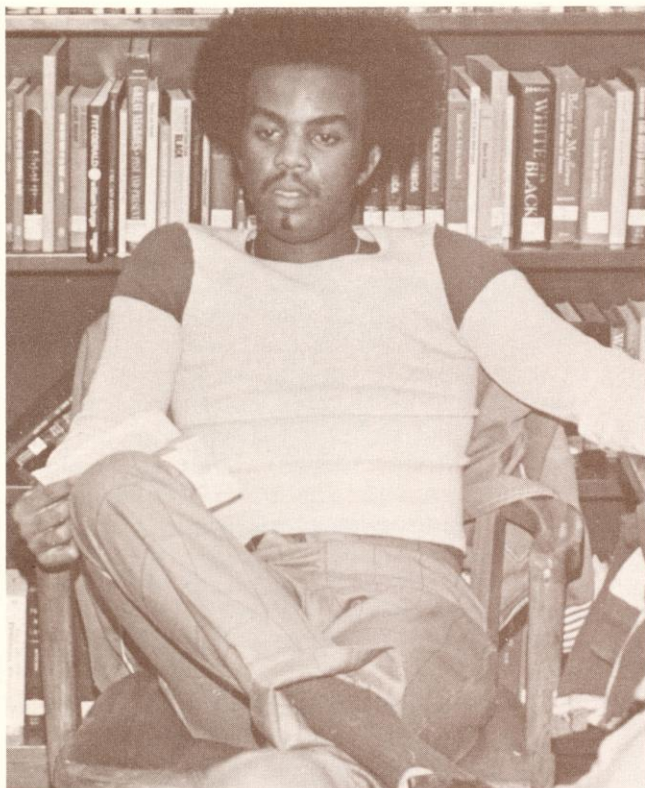
October 24 Equal Opportunity Luncheon for Indiana High School Counselors hosted by SBE

October 30—
November 14 Top Five Junior Program — to expose high school students to campus life from an engineering student's point of view

November 11 **Dr. Robert Eubanks**, civil engineer — Black Cultural Center guest speaker

COVER DESIGN AND TITLE — George Smith

The title "Cornerstone," was selected because it exemplifies a foundation, building block, and support for our future activities and projects.



Editor — George Smith (EE)

INTRODUCTION

A New Era at Purdue by Gilliam Duvall

As our news-staff prepares for its next publication for The Society of Black Engineers, I would like to announce a new era in Purdue engineering. The fall semester of 1974 marks the largest Black engineering student enrollment in the University's 105 year history.

At present there are one-hundred and four Blacks enrolled in the ten engineering disciplines here at Purdue University. This is a 30% increase in the number of black engineers from last semester. This year black freshmen in engineering have come from many different parts of the United States because they have heard that Purdue is one of the best engineering schools in the country. I would like to think that our first publication, the summer of 1974, had a lot to do with making the opportunities present here at Purdue better known to the public.

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Society Calendar — Fall Semester "74"

Publications Staff

George Smith — Chairman

Gilliam Duvall

Marvin Wright

Julian Weathers

John R. Cason

WHAT'S HAPPENING

New York Field Trip

Recently, Anthony Harris, President of the Society of Black Engineers and Vice Chairman of the American Society of Mechanical Engineers, along with Edward Coleman, Tutorial Assistance Chairman, attended the ASME Student Design Conference in New York. These are the results of their trip as stated by Anthony Harris.

"We left Lafayette at about 10:30 p.m. Saturday, October 5, and approximately 18 hours, 800 miles and nine sore backs later, we arrived in New York City for the ASME Student Design Conference, which, by the way, was organized by our own Professor Ragsdell.

"While there, we stayed at the beautiful Statler Hilton Hotel in downtown Manhattan, which is across from Madison Square Gardens and only a couple of blocks from Times Square.

"On Monday, the seventh, we attended the Mechanism Conference at which Prof. Ragsdell, and two Purdue graduate students, Gary Gabrielle and Ron Root, made us very proud by presenting two very interesting papers. That night there was an orientation session given for the students.

"The next day the Student Design Competition began. Papers were presented by teams from Oklahoma, Connecticut, Illinois, Massachusetts, Texas, Nebraska and California. Afterwards we were taken on a tour of the United Engineering Center where we had lunch with Mr. William Reaser, who took us on a tour of the U.N.

"On Tuesday evening the awards session was held. First prize was given to Nebraska (design of a Polycentric Leg Prostheses), second prize to Texas (a concept for a Fixed Orientation Abulatory Vehicle), and third prize went to Oklahoma (An Improved Approach to Solar Energy Collector Design). Later, some of us were lucky enough to get tickets to a basketball game in Madison Square Gardens.

"Wednesday, we attended the Design Technology Transfer Conference and took in some of the sights of the city.

"On Thursday, October 10, we returned home."

From the editors:

Trips of this nature are inspiring to engineering students in that it exemplifies the necessity of communicating technological concepts away from the academic environment.



Standing: (left) President Anthony Harris (ME) (right) Vice President John Logan (CE)



Advisor Prof. Arthur Bond (left)



Advisor Saunie Tayor (right)

Equal Opportunity Luncheon by George Smith

Purdue University has an interest in the development of minorities and females in engineering. On Thursday, October 24, the Society of Black Engineers and the Society of Women Engineers served as host and hostess to a luncheon which initiated an entire day of *Equal Opportunity in Engineering* programs for high school counselors. Guest speakers for the event were Professor Donna S. Frohreich, coordinator of programs for women in engineering, Ms. Janice Voss, a junior in engineering sciences, Mr. Anthony Harris, President of the Society of Black Engineers, and Professor Arthur Bond, coordinator of programs in engineering for minority students.

More involvement in programs of this nature should be stressed in the future.



SBE Representative Allison Bond (left)



SBE Representative Kevin Mason (right)



SBE Representative Ed Coleman (right)

An Inspirational Profile

by John Cason

On October 14, 1974, the Society of Black Engineers guest speaker was Mr. Ed Barnett, a former Purdue Black Engineering student and now a representative of Proctor and Gamble's Charmin division.

Being a former engineering student here at Purdue, it was quite easy for Mr. Barnett to relate to all the members of the Society.

During his informal talk Mr. Barnett mentioned quite a few personal objectives which should be considered by prospective engineers:

1. Attitude toward job and fellow workers.
2. Ability to communicate effectively.
3. Importance of High Goals.
4. Determination to excell.

There is a world of opportunities for the Black Engineer. To capitalize on these opportunities we must have high goals. Fulfilling our objectives and goals will be a challenge. The desire to succeed will help overcome most

obstacles that we may encounter.

Mr. Ed Barnett exhibits the desire of a Black Engineer to achieve, let us follow his example.

The Society of Black Engineers would like to congratulate the Graduates from the schools of Engineering and Technology for the 1974-1975 school year.

December 1974

Frederick S. Cooper, E.E.
Clarence W. Dickason, Jr., E.E.
Leonard J. Holland, E.E.
John R. Jones, E.E.

May 1975

Edward A. Coleman, M.E.
Anthony Harris, M.E.
Bobby R. Noel, E.E.T.
Bradley A. Thomas, E.E.

Best of Luck in your future endeavors,
The Editors.



Guest Speaker — Ed Barnett, Purdue Alumni (IE), first President of SBE.

Industry Visits the Society of Black Engineers by John Logan

On Monday, October 7, the Society of Black Engineers met with representatives of Inland Steel, Litton Industries, and Amoco Oil Company. The representatives of Inland Steel presented a very informative slide production on interviewing techniques. The program stressed the importance of the resume, a knowledge of personal occupational objectives, and proper dress standards.

The purpose behind scheduling corporations to speak at meetings is to acquaint SBE members with the many opportunities present in industry.

Committee Outline

In order to achieve its goals, the Society of Black Engineers has found it useful to form various committees to concentrate on the needs of its organization.

The Publications Committee, George Smith, chairman, is aimed at conveying the goals and activities of the SBE through magazine articles, newspaper articles, and newsletters.

The Tutorial Committee, Ed Coleman, chairman, offers academic assistance in the various freshman and sophomore level courses.

The Publicity Committee, Allison Bond, chairperson, advertises the activities of the SBE.

The Resume Committee, Kevin Mason, chairman, compiles personal and scholastic information of interest to industry.

The Membership and Development Committee, Melvin Dorsey, chairman, aids in the recruitment of incoming black freshmen in engineering for the SBE.

The Projects Committee, Brian Harris, chairman, formulates all social and business activities for the SBE.

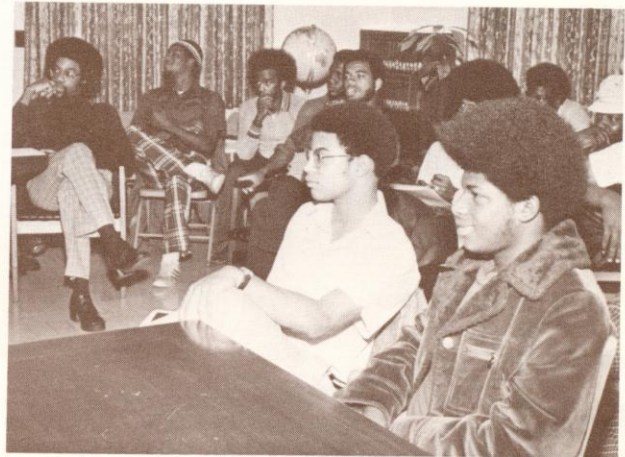
Banquet Plans by Brian Harris

The Society of Black Engineers is planning its first major banquet. It is tentatively scheduled to occur early in the spring semester.

The banquet will be expressly for black engineering and technology students and their guests, with representatives from various

national corporations in attendance. It is the hope of the SBE that the banquet will be funded by companies interested in helping minority students.

The success of this endeavor will depend entirely on the total participation of Society of Black Engineers members.



EDITORIALS

Let's Come Together by George Smith

Within the past several months, The Society of Black Engineers (SBE) has made tremendous progress. Our membership is now at a peak. To continue this progress we must have a constant influx of ideas. Future achievement will be proportional to the participation and involvement of young Black engineers that arises in the years to come. To promote and insure the future existence of this Society, we intend to contact Black engineering students at colleges which offer an Engineering curriculum with hopes of forming a national Society of Black Engineers.

Engineering and Its Compliment: Technology by Marvin L. Wright

In the last decade, there have been a number of articles written trying to pit the various sectors of the engineering team against one another, thus creating undue animosity between engineers, technologists and technicians.

Engineers graduating from accredited engineering programs are considered to be innovators or creators of new processes, products and systems, with the ability to solve specific problems. This consideration is given to an engineer primarily

(Continued on back page)

because of his advanced mathematical background and knowledge of the science and practical judgment utilized in solving problems.

Engineering technologists from an equally accredited program are considered the practical appliers of engineering principles. They are individuals who are capable of organizing people as well as the processes, products and systems innovated by engineers. The curriculum is similar to engineering in origin, except for the theory and advanced mathematics required of engineers.

The two programs complement each other and together supply graduates satisfying a wide range of career objectives.

In any case, both are Bachelor of Science degree graduates, both generally accept positions in industry, both with personalities that are different only in that the engineering technologists are "thing and doing" oriented, where the engineers are math and science oriented.

It is my belief that the educators are at fault for not listening to the people of industry who say there are needs for technologists as well as engineers in industry.

What Is The Answer? by Cornelius Weathers

I saw recently, in the preface of a survey put out by some Humanities people, a statement that I though was, at the very least, worthy of discussion.

The statement was in essence, "We are distressed at the small number of Blacks in Engineering."

DISTRESSED. Not "concerned with" or "working to increase" but **DISTRESSED.** This is an unfortunate choice of words. It implies a certain hopelessness about increasing the presently small

number of Blacks in Engineering. It suggests that, somebody somewhere is compromising their hopes of being an engineer for the life of, say a computer programmer or house painter. It seems to ignore the fact that Engineering takes a lot of special stamina, not only academically but emotionally, and a lot of people just don't have this.

To be an engineer, a person must have the kind of math and science background that is so often underemphasized in our Black high schools. Being distressed about it won't help a thing.

Those of us who are engineering students can and do help the situation via tutoring in connection with the Society of Black Engineers, but we can not do it alone. Those of you in Humanities could go into the high schools and junior colleges and urge Black students to see a counselor if they have any questions about Engineering. A career in Engineering is a decision that a student should make with the advise of duely experienced personnel. Maybe this way we can *all* be a little less distressed.

Closing Remarks

In this, the first publication on the Society of Black Engineers Newsletter, it was our concern to try and inform the Purdue student body of a new professional society on campus.

The Society is totally committed to helping Purdue in producing the most highly qualified and skilled Engineers and Technologists.

This Newsletter, we hope, has enlightened your thoughts and questions of our ideals and future plans. Note: our next publication will be in late March.

"DEDICATED TO A BETTER TOMORROW"

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